

CC in the Cloud Technical Community (Cloud-TC) – Meeting Minutes

7:47 AM PST 2/5/2025

Call to Order: 0802
Meeting Lead: Joshua BRICKMAN
Attendees: 13
Member Roster: 83
Next Meeting: Wednesday February 19, 2025

Highlights:

- NIAP has released Policy Letter #32 for NIAP Cloud SaaS Evaluations

Old Business:

- Review of previous meeting minutes by Josh B.
 - o Brief clarification on the differences between a TD and a “Waiver” in the case of the Microsoft Intune evaluation.
 - Jade S clarified that in many cases TQ’s were submitted by the lab, however separate discussions between the Lab, validators, and NIAP were also had where rationales regarding other issues were discussed and submitted. Resolutions for all issues did not always result in a TD, and in some cases resulted in an approved alternative way of testing or type of evidence submitted regarding an SFR or SAR.

New Business:

- Josh B started a discussion on the new Policy Letter #32 regarding NIAP Cloud SaaS Evaluations released by NIAP in recent days.
 - o Josh walked through each section of the Policy Letter and highlighted each new requirement listed.
 - o Discussion on *"Mutual Authentication: the Target of Evaluation (TOE) must implement mutual authentication when using secure communication protocols"*.
 - Jade S clarified that where mutual authentication is available in an SFR, it should be implemented as such.
 - o Discussion on *"Platform Functionality: if the TOE relies on the platform to implement any functionality, the platform must be on the NIAP Product Compliant List"*.
 - Josh B raised a point that if the platform is an OS, the evaluation of that OS may take long enough that the OS becomes outdated by the time it is posted to the PCL.
 - Jade suggested that a TQ should be submitted in those cases, and pointed to the Suitability review section of Policy Letter 32 which states:
"the CCTL must submit a list of security functional requirements (SFRs) and security assurance requirements (SARs) that are likely to require TQs (as per

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Assurance and Evaluation Activities above) to NIAP for a suitability review as part of the check-in package;

resolution of some TQs may be required to complete the suitability review and proceed to kick-off”.

- Josh B suggested that a reference to the CCITC Guidance document in the policy letter might have been useful for additional context.
- This requirement is important since not all OS vendors are getting CC evaluated or keep up with valid CC certification status, and is a huge step forward in sending a message to OS vendors that this is an emerging requirement.
- Discussion on some of the logged comments in GitHub relating to GitHub discussion #184 for Policy Letter #32.
 - Regarding Policy statement:
“All cloud-based evaluations submitted to NIAP claiming conformance against PPs that are capable of being used with applications in the cloud...”
Tyrone S pointed out that based on the work of the Cloud-TC and NIAP’s analysis on MDM PP, there are currently no such PP’s available yet.
 - Jade S commented that the MDM PP does in fact attempt to incorporate cloud scenarios, and no other PP’s come near to what the MDM PP has incorporated. PP authors aren’t always cloud-focused people and that further collaboration is required for PP’s that want to include cloud use cases.
- Brandon H provided a status update on Guidance document amendments.
 - The majority of updates addressing German scheme feedback have been made.
 - Two more weeks will be allocated for final review by Cloud-TC members after which a vote will be held on to confirm the official release of the next version of the Guidance document.
 - All review efforts should specifically focus on the changes implemented from the GitHub issues pertaining to German Scheme Feedback that are tagged as *“to incorporate”*.
- Josh highlighted the new *‘Supporting Documents related to Cryptography’* section on the CC Portal, and noted he would request a similar section for future Cloud-TC documents.

Questions/Follow-ups:

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End of Meeting – Adjourned 0855 PST